

SEMELE

prefers rich, well-drained soil. Propagate by division or seed in spring.
S. androgyna (Climbing butcher’s broom). Evergreen climber, twining in upper part, branched and bearing ovate cladodes, 2–4in (5–10cm) long. H 22ft (7m). In early summer, bears star-shaped, cream flowers in notches on cladode margins, followed by orange-red berries. Z10–11

SEMQIAQULEGIA

RANUNCULACEAE

Genus of perennials, grown for their flowers. These differ from those of *Aquilegia*, with which it is sometimes included, by having no spurs. Excellent for rock gardens. Fully hardy. Requires a sunny position and moist but well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in fall.
S. ecalcarata illus. p.341.

SEMIARUNDINARIA

GRAMINEAE/POACEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES.
S. fastuosa, syn. *Arundinaria fastuosa* (Narihira bamboo), illus. p.287.

SEMPERVIVUM

Houseleek

CRASSULACEAE

Genus of evergreen succulent perennials that spread by short stolons. Grown for their symmetrical rosettes of ovate to strap-shaped, pointed, fleshy leaves. Forms ground-hugging mats, suitable for rock gardens, screes, walls, banks, and alpine houses. Flowers are star-shaped with 8–16 spreading petals. Fully hardy. Requires sun and gritty soil. Takes several years to reach flowering size. Rosettes die after flowering but leave numerous offsets. Propagate by offsets in summer.
S. arachnoideum (Cobweb houseleek; illus. p.377). Evergreen, mat-forming perennial. H 2–5in (5–12cm), S 4in (10cm) or more. Rosettes of ovate, fleshy leaves, with red tips, are covered in a web of white hairs. Bears loose clusters of star-shaped, rose-red flowers in summer. Z4–10
S. ‘Blood Tip’ (illus. p.377). Evergreen, basal-rosetted, mat-forming succulent. H to 4in (10cm), S to 1ft (30cm). Has thick, green leaves strongly suffused purple-red with deeper red, bristlelike tips. Z5–9
S. calcareum (illus. p.377). Variable, evergreen, mat-forming, basal-rosetted perennial. H 2–3in (5–7cm), S 8–10in (20–25cm). Has bluish-green leaves with dark reddish-brown tips. In summer, erect stems bear terminal clusters of star-shaped, red-based, creamy-white flowers. Excellent for a trough or on a dry wall. Z5–9.
‘Extra’ (illus. p.377) has intense, dark leaf tips.
S. ciliosum illus. p.375.
S. ‘Commander Hay’. Evergreen, basal-rosetted perennial. H 6in (15cm), S to 1ft (30cm). Mainly grown for its very large, dark red rosettes to 4in (10cm) across. Terminal clusters of dull greenish-red flowers are produced in summer. Z4–10
S. ‘Gallivarda’ (illus. p.377). Evergreen, mat-forming, basal-rosetted perennial. H 2–3in (5–8cm), S 8–10in (20–25cm). Red

leaves turn to orange-red in summer, then to purplish-red. Z5–9
S. giuseppii (illus. p.377). Vigorous, evergreen, prostrate perennial. H in flower 3–4in (8–10cm), S 4in (10cm). Leaves are hairy, especially in spring, and have dark spots at tips. Produces terminal clusters of star-shaped, deep pink or red flowers in summer. Z4–10
S. globiferum subsp. globiferum. See *Jovibarba sobolifera*. **subsp. hirtum** see *Jovibarba hirta*.
S. grandiflorum. Evergreen, basal-rosetted perennial. H 4in (10cm), S to 8in (20cm). Variable, densely haired, red-tinted, dark green rosettes exude a goatlike smell when crushed. Produces loose, terminal clusters of yellow-green flowers, stained purple in centers, on long flower stems in summer. Prefers humus-rich, acidic soil. Z4–10
S. ‘Gulle Dame’ (illus. p.377). Evergreen, mat-forming, basal-rosetted perennial. H 2–3in (5–8cm), S 8–10in (20–25cm). Has dark red leaves with long, white hairs, in spring and summer, gradually changing to green in winter. Z5–9
S. ‘Kappa’ (illus. p.377). Evergreen, mat-forming, basal-rosetted perennial. H 2–3in (5–8cm), S 6–8in (15–20cm). Deep purple-red leaves are covered in cobwebs of white hairs. Z5–9
S. montanum (illus. p.377). Evergreen, mat-forming perennial. H 3–6in (10–15cm), S 4in (10cm). Has dark green rosettes of fleshy, hairy leaves. Star-shaped, wine-red flowers are borne in terminal clusters in summer. A variable plant that hybridizes freely. Z4–10
S. ‘Rosie’ (illus. p.377). Evergreen, mat-forming, open-rosetted perennial. H 2–3in (5–8cm), S 8–10in (20–25cm). Green-flushed, purple-red leaves have short, marginal hairs. Z5–9
S. tectorum (Common houseleek; illus. p.377). Vigorous, evergreen perennial. H 4–6in (10–15cm), S to 8in (20cm). Has thick, bristle-tipped, blue-green leaves, often suffused red-purple. In summer, bears clusters of star-shaped, reddish-purple flowers on stems 1ft (30cm) tall. Z4–10

SENECIO

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of annuals, biennials, succulent and non-succulent perennials, and evergreen shrubs, subshrubs, small trees, and twining climbers, grown for their foliage and usually daisylike flower heads. Some shrubby species are now included in *Brachyglottis*. Shrubs are good for coastal gardens. Fully hardy to frost tender. Most prefer full sun and well-drained soil. Propagate shrubs and climbers by semiripe cuttings in summer, annuals by seed in spring, perennials by division in spring. ☉All parts may cause severe discomfort if ingested.
S. articulatus. See *Curio articulata*.
S. cineraria. See *Jacobea maritima*.
S. clivorum ‘Desdemona’. See *Ligularia dentata* ‘Desdemona’.
S. compactus. See *Brachyglottis compacta*.
S. confusus. See *Pseudogynoxys chenopodioides*.
S. cruentus. See *Pericallis x hybrida*.
S. Dunedin Hybrids. See *Brachyglottis* Dunedin Group.

S. elegans. Moderately fast-growing, upright annual. H 1½ft (45cm), S 6in (15cm). Has ovate, deeply lobed, deep green leaves. Daisylike, purple flower heads are borne in summer. Z9–11
S. grandifolius, syn. *Telanthophora grandifolia*. Evergreen, erect, robust-stemmed shrub. H 10–15ft (3–5m), S 6–10ft (2–3m). Ovate, toothed, boldly veined leaves, 8–18in (20–45cm) long, are glossy, rich green above, red-brown-hairy beneath. In winter–spring, bears terminal clusters, 1ft (30cm) across, of small, daisylike, yellow flower heads. Z10–12 (min. 41°F/5°C).
S. grayi of gardens. See *Brachyglottis* Dunedin Group.
S. x hybridus. See *Pericallis x hybrida*.
S. laxifolius. See *Brachyglottis laxifolia*.
S. laxifolius of gardens. See *Brachyglottis* Dunedin Group.
S. macroglossus (Natal ivy, Wax vine). Evergreen, woody-stemmed, twining climber. H 10ft (3m). Leaves are sharply triangular, fleshy-textured and glossy. Loose clusters of daisylike flower heads, each with a few white ray petals and a central, yellow disc, are borne mainly in winter. Z10–12 (min. 41–45°F/5–7°C). **‘Variegatus’** illus. p.464.
S. maritimus. See *Jacobea maritima*.
S. mikanioides. See *Delairea odorata*.
S. monroi. See *Brachyglottis monroi*.
S. przewalskii. See *Ligularia przewalskii*.
S. pulcher illus. p.278.
S. reinoldii. See *Brachyglottis rotundifolia*.
S. rotundifolius. See *Brachyglottis rotundifolia*.
S. rowleyanus. See *Curio rowleyana*.
S. smithii. Bushy perennial. H 3–4ft (1–1.2m), S 2½–3ft (75cm–1m). Woolly stems are clothed with long, ovate, toothed, leathery, dark green leaves. Daisylike, white flower heads with yellow centers are borne in terminal clusters, up to 6in (15cm) across, in early summer. Likes a boggy conditions. Z8–10
S. ‘Spring Glory’. See *Pericallis x hybrida* ‘Spring Glory’.
S. ‘Sunshine’. See *Brachyglottis* Dunedin Group ‘Sunshine’.
S. tamoides. Evergreen, woody-stemmed, twining climber. H 15ft (5m) or more. Has ivy-shaped, light green leaves. In fall–winter, produces daisylike, yellow flower heads with only a few ray petals. Z10–12 (min. 41–45°F/5–7°C).

SENNA

CAESALPINIACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of evergreen trees, shrubs, and perennials, grown for their pealike flowers. Fully hardy to frost tender. Needs full sun and moist but well-drained soil. Propagate by seed sown in spring, or by semiripe cuttings in summer. Divide perennials in spring.
S. artemisioides, syn. *Cassia artemisioides* (Silver cassia, Wormwood cassia). Evergreen, erect to spreading, wiry shrub. H and S 3–6ft (1–2m). Leaves each have 6–8 linear leaflets covered with silky, white down. Bears axillary spikes of cup-shaped, yellow flowers from winter to early summer. Z10–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)
S. corymbosa, syn. *Cassia corymbosa*, illus. p.459.

S. didymobotrya, syn. *Cassia didymobotrya* (Golden wonder), illus. p.459.
S. x floribunda, syn. *Cassia corymbosa* var. *plurijuga*, *C. x floribunda*. Vigorous, evergreen or deciduous, rounded shrub with robust stems. H and S 5–6ft (1.5–2m). Bright green leaves consist of 4–6 ovate leaflets. Bears very large clusters of bowl-shaped, rich yellow flowers in late summer. Z10–12 (min. 45°F/7°C)
S. siamea, syn. *Cassia siamea*. Fast-growing, evergreen, rounded tree. H and S 25–30ft (8–10m) or more. Leaves, 6–12in (15–30cm) long, have 7–12 pairs of elliptic leaflets. Large terminal panicles of small, cup-shaped, bright yellow flowers are borne in spring, followed by flat, dark brown pods, to 9in (23cm) long. Z12 (min. 16–18°C/61–64°F)

SEQUOIA

CUPRESSACEAE

See also CONIFERS.
S. sempervirens (Redwood) illus. p.97.

SEQUIADENDRON

CUPRESSACEAE

See also CONIFERS.
S. giganteum (Giant redwood, Wellingtonia) illus. p.98. **‘Pendulum’** is a weeping conifer. H 30ft (10m), S 6ft (2m) or more. Bark is thick, soft, fibrous and red-brown. Has spiraled, needlelike, incurved, gray-green leaves that darken and become glossy. Z6–8

SERAPIAS

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS.
S. cordigera. Deciduous, terrestrial orchid. H 16in (40cm). Produces lance-shaped leaves; leaf bases and stem bracts are usually spotted or veined purple. In spring, spikes, 10–18in (25–45cm) high, bear 4–10 flowers, each with a deep purple to maroon hood, and a heart-shaped, dark purple, hairy lip with 2 purple-black ridges at its base. Grow in partial shade. Z6–9

SERENOA

ARECACEAE/PALMAE

Genus of one species of evergreen fan palm, grown for its foliage. Frost tender. Requires full light or partial shade and well-drained soil. Water potted plants moderately in growing season, less at other times. Propagate by seed or suckers in spring. Red spider mite may be a problem.
S. repens (Saw palmetto, Scrub palmetto). Evergreen, rhizomatous fan palm, usually stemless. H 2–3ft (60cm–1m), S 6ft (2m) or more. Palmate leaves, 18–30in (45–75cm) wide, are gray to blue-green, and divided into 6–20 strap-shaped lobes. Clusters of tiny, fragrant, cream flowers are hidden among leaves in summer, and followed by egg-shaped, purple-black fruits. Z9–11

SERISSA

RUBIACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs, grown for their overall appearance. Frost tender. Needs sun or partial shade and fertile,